

Grant Skaggs

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Site: grantskaggs.com

Experience

March 2024 **Phind** — *Founding Engineer*

- Present
 - Implemented Phind's Enterprise offering and brought it to market
 - Enabled a novel **Generative UI** by re-architecting Phind's Next.js frontend
 - Reduced page load times by **over 25%** via frontend optimizations
 - Researched agentic approaches for code generation using LLMs
 - Created Python micro-services and an Electron Desktop app for running LLM-generated code

Sept 2022 - **Applied Intuition** — *Software Engineer*

- March 2024
 - Developed software for self-driving car simulation, iterating closely with enterprise customers
 - Migrated map querying infrastructure to Apache Spark, resulting in a **15x latency reduction**
 - Deployed distributed systems for running geographic data pipelining in the cloud using kubernetes

Summer **Duolingo** — *Software Engineering Intern*

- 2020
 - Created a prize for premium subscribers of the iOS app, using Swift and UIKit
 - Implemented the backend API in Python, Java, and PostgreSQL

Summer **University of Texas at Austin** — *Undergraduate Researcher*

- 2019
 - Applied recurrent neural networks to cache data prefetching in modern computer architectures
 - Trained an LSTM neural model using TensorFlow and Python to prefetch addresses

Education

May 2022 **University of Texas at Austin** — *Turing Scholar Honors Program*

B.S. Computer Science & Philosophy Minor; **GPA: 3.96**

Coursework: Algorithms, Data Structures, Operating Systems, Computer Architecture, Data Mining, Reinforcement Learning, Cryptography, Quantum Computing, Competitive Programming

Publications

Spring 2022 **Genetic Algorithms for the Simulation of Flower Pigmentation Patterns**

- Applied genetic algorithms to fine-tune parameters for the reaction-diffusion differential equations which produce flower pigmentation patterns
- Published as a **20-page honors thesis** at the University of Texas; read more at grantskaggs.com/thesis

Leadership

Spring 2021 **Texas 4000 for Cancer** — *Equipment Manager*

- Aug 2022
 - Coordinated training and logistics for a **4000 mile charity bike ride** from Austin to Alaska
 - Helped fundraise over **\$300,000** for various cancer research and support services

Spring 2021 **University of Texas Computer Science Department** — *Teaching Assistant*

- Held office hours and graded projects for an honors computer graphics course

Skills

Proficient: Python, C/C++, Next.js, Typescript, React, SQL / Postgres, OpenAI API

Familiar: AWS, Kubernetes, Apache Spark, Java, HTML / CSS, Bash

Personal

Awards: High School Valedictorian, AIME Qualifier, Science Olympiad Gold Medalist, USACO Gold Ranking, National Merit Scholar

Hobbies: Salsa dancing, run clubs and marathons, tennis leagues